

Gabor Brody

RESEARCH SCIENTIST / LECTURER
COGNITIVE SCIENCE · DEVELOPMENTAL PSYCHOLOGY

Department of Psychology & Program in Cognitive Science, Yale University
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Position

Yale University

RESEARCH SCIENTIST / LECTURER

- Department of Psychology
- Program in Cognitive Science
- Department of Linguistics (by courtesy)

New Haven, CT

2025 - present

Brown University

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER

- Department of Cognitive and Psychological Sciences

Providence, RI

2020 - 2025

Education

Central European University

PHD COGNITIVE SCIENCE

- Advisors: Gergely Csibra, Ágnes Melinda Kovács
- Thesis: Indexing Objects in Vision and Communication

Vienna, Austria

2014 - 2020

Eötvös Loránd University

BA & MA PSYCHOLOGY

- Advisor: Ildikó Király
- Specialization in Cognitive and Developmental Psychology

Budapest, Hungary

2008 - 2013

Visiting Research Fellowships

2018-2019 Harvard Lab for Developmental Studies, Advisor: Elizabeth Spelke; Harvard, Cambridge, MA

2016 Center of Brain and Cognition, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Advisor: Luca Bonatti; Barcelona, Spain

Publications

JOURNAL ARTICLES

* equal contributions

- [1] Brody, G., Mazalik, P., Feiman, R. (in press). Object perception encodes mutually exclusive possibilities. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*.
- [2] Brody, G., Csibra, G. (2025). Discourse referents in infancy. *Psychological Review*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1037/rev0000545>
- [3] Brody, G., Feiman, R.*, Aravind, A.* (2024). Why do children think words are mutually exclusive? *Psychological Science*, 35(12), 1315-1324. <https://doi.org/10.1177/09567976241287732>
- [4] Pomiechowska, B., Brody, G., Téglás, E., Kovács, Á. M. (2024). Early-emerging combinatorial thought: Human infants flexibly combine kind and quantity concepts. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 121(29), e2315149121. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2315149121>

- [5] **Brody, G.**, Feiman, R. (2024). Mapping words to the world: Adults, but not children, understand how mismatching descriptions refer. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 153(4), 1053-1065. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001544>
- [6] **Brody, G.**, Feiman, R. (2024). Polysemy does not exist, at least not in the relevant sense. *Mind & Language*, 39(2), 179-200. <https://doi.org/10.1111/mila.12462>
- [7] **Brody, G***, Revencu, B.*, Csibra, G. (2023). Images of objects are interpreted as symbols: A case study of automatic size measurement. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 152(4), 1146-1157. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xge0001544>
- [8] **Brody, G.**, Olah, K., Király, I., Biro, S. (2022). Individuation of agents based on psychological properties in 10-month-old infants. *Infancy*, 27(2), 360-381. <https://doi.org/10.1111/infa.12453>
- [9] Pomiechowska, B., **Brody, G.**, Csibra, G., Gliga, T. (2021). Twelve-month-olds disambiguate new words using mutual-exclusivity inferences. *Cognition*, 213, 104691. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2021.104691>
- [10] Elekes, F., **Brody, G.**, Halász, E., Király, I. (2016). Enhanced encoding of the co-actor's target stimuli during a shared non-motor task. *Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology*, 69(12), 2446-2458. <https://doi.org/10.1080/17470218.2015.1120332>
- [11] Oláh K., Elekes F., **Brody G.**, Király I. (2014). Social category formation is induced by cues of sharing knowledge in young children. *PLOS ONE*, 9(7), e101680. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0101680>

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

- [12] **Brody, G.**, Mazalik, P., Feiman, R. (2024). Object files encode possible object identities, but not possible locations. *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 46, 1782-1788.
- [13] Revencu, B., Pomiechowska, B., **Brody, G.**, Csibra, G. (2024). Fifteen-month-olds accept arbitrary shapes as symbols of familiar kind tokens. *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 46, 4208-4214.
- [14] **Brody, G.**, Feiman, R. (2022). Mapping words to the world: Adults prioritize grammar, but children prioritize descriptions. *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 44, 1032-1038.
- [15] Torma, C., **Brody, G.**, Aravind, A. (2021). More than the sum of its parts: Acquiring semantically complex quantifiers. *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 43, 2035-2041.

BOOK CHAPTERS

- [16] **Brody, G.**, Aravind, A. (in press). Pragmatic Development. In *Cambridge Companion to Child Syntax*. Cambridge University Press.
- [17] **Brody, G.**, Rouillard, V., Asherov, D., Aravind, A. (2024). Evaluating the Effectiveness of AI Source Disclosure in Human-AI Communication. *An MIT Exploration of Generative AI*. MIT Press.

DISSERTATION

- [18] **Brody, G.** (2020). *Indexing Objects in Vision and Communication*. Doctoral dissertation, Central European University.

Presentations

SELECTED INVITED TALKS

Spring 2026 *Variables keep them(selves) separate*. Invited talk at the Discourse Files symposium, Collège de France, Paris, France

Fall 2025 *Object files represent possible identities, but not locations*. Invited talk at the DevLogic Workshop, Yale University, New Haven, CT

Fall 2025 *What do descriptions describe?* Invited talk at the Vienna Linguistics Colloquium, Vienna, Austria

Spring 2024 *How context shapes what symbols mean?* Invited talk at MIT BCS CogLunch, Cambridge, MA

Autumn 2023 *On conceptual object representation in infancy*. Invited talk at Harvard Lab for Developmental studies (LDS) seminar series, Cambridge, MA

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Knobe, J., Aravind, A. & **Brody, G.** (2026). Two ways of not being a real king: Privativity and dual character. Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Baltimore, MD
- Brody, G.**, Azar, K. & Keil, F. (2026). What is seen as impossible depends on what question we ask. Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Baltimore, MD
- Roszkowski, M., Aravind, A. & **Brody, G.** (2026). Reference resolution suffers in the absence of a formal link. Poster presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Baltimore, MD
- Anvari, A. & **Brody, G.** (2026). We need more logic to study the psychological reality of logic. Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Society of Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Baltimore, MD
- Brody, G.**, Azar, K. & Keil, F. (2026). What is seen as impossible depends on what question we ask. Talk presented at the Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM) Conference, Philadelphia, PA
- Brody, G.**, Aravind, A. & Feiman, R. (2025). Infants' mutual exclusivity expectations are modulated by information structure. Talk presented at the Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD) 50, Boston, MA
- Brody, G.**, Mazalik, P. & Feiman, R. (2025). Mutually exclusive future possibilities are represented in vision. Poster presented at the Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary
- Brody, G.**, Broomfield, C. & Feiman, R. (2025). Counting the number of objects in an object-individuation paradigm. Poster presented at the Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD), Budapest, Hungary
- Brody, G.**, Mazalik, P. & Feiman, R. (2024). Object files encode possible object identities, but not possible locations. Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (COGSCI), Rotterdam, Netherlands
- Revenu, B., **Brody, G.**, Pomiechowska, B. & Csibra, G. (2024) Not a pipe: 15-month-olds accept arbitrary objects as symbols for familiar kind tokens. Talk presented at Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development (BCCCD) Budapest, Hungary
- Brody, G.***, Mazalik, P.*, Feiman, R. (2023) Object files represent possibilities. Poster presented at the Annual meeting of the Society of Philosophy and Psychology (SPP), Pittsburgh, PA (* equal contribution)
- Brody, G.**, Feiman, R. & Aravind, A. (2022). 2-year olds derive mutual exclusivity inferences from contrastive focus. Talk presented at the Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD), Boston, MA
- Brody, G.** & Feiman, R. (2022). Mapping words to the world: Adults prioritize grammar, but children prioritize descriptions. Talk presented at the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (COGSCI), Toronto, Canada
- Brody, G.** & Feiman, R. (2022). Polysemy does not exist at least not in the relevant sense., Poster at the Society of Philosophy and Psychology, Milan, Italy
- Brody, G.**, Feiman, R. & Aravind, A. (2022). 2-year olds derive mutual exclusivity inferences from contrastive focus, Talk presented at II. Experiments in Linguistic Meaning (ELM) Conference, Philadelphia, PA
- Brody, G.** & Feiman, R. (2022). In reference identification, children rely on descriptions, but adults prioritize grammar, Poster at the Cognitive Development Society conference, Madison, WI
- Brody, G.** & Feiman, R. (2022). The role of grammar and descriptions in referent identification. Virtual talk presented at the 2022 Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary
- Torma, C., **Brody, G.** & Aravind, A. (2020). Decomposing Both. Virtual talk presented at Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD), Boston, MA
- Brody, G.** & Csibra, G. (2019). Object representation without object files at 10 months of age. Symposium paper presented at the 2019 Biennial Meeting of the Society for Research in Child Development, Baltimore, MD

- Brody, G.** & Csibra, G. (2018). Spatiotemporal and conceptual object individuation are not integrated in 10-month-old infants . Poster presented at the XX Biennial International Conference on Infant Studies, Philadelphia, PA
- Brody, G.** & Csibra, G. (2018). Spatiotemporal vs Conceptual object individuation . Poster at the 2018 Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary
- Pomiechowska, B., **Brody, G.**, Teglas, E. & Kovacs, A.M. (2018) Do 12-month-olds use the principle of compositionality to interpret complex noun phrases? Poster at the 2018 Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary
- Brody, G.**, Király, I., Kovacs, A. M. (2015). Interference and priming in spontaneous belief computation. Poster at the 2015 Budapest Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary
- Elekes, F., Oláh, K. & **Brody, G.**, Király, I. (2014). Adopting a Goal Centered Generalization Strategy in the Context of Tool Choices at 18 Months of age. Poster at the XIX Biennial International Conference on Infant Studies, Berlin, Germany.
- Brody, G.**, Oláh, K., Király, I. & Bíró, S. (2014). Individuating abstract agents based on preference demonstration. Poster at the XIX Biennial International Conference on Infant Studies, Berlin, Germany.
- Brody G.**, Oláh K., Király I. & Bíró S. (2013) How do infants individuate abstract agents? Poster at the 2013 Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development. Budapest, Hungary
- Brody G.**, Király I. & Bíró S. (2013) Tracking others perspective in a MOT paradigm. Poster at the 2013 Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development. Budapest, Hungary
- Oláh K., Elekes F., **Brody G.** & Király I. (2013). Shared knowledge as the basis of social categorization. Poster at the 2013 Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development. Budapest, Hungary

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2024	Research Seed Award, Brown University Co-PI, Title: Children understand that what you say depends on how you say it.; Co-PI: Roman Feiman	\$ 50,000
2023	Funding for impact papers on Generative AI, MIT Co-PI, Title: Evaluating the effectiveness of AI-identification in human-AI communication; Co-PI: Athulya Aravind	\$ 50,000
2021	Brown University Salomon Grant, Brown University Researcher, Title: The role of grammar and descriptions in referent identification; PI: Roman Feiman	\$ 15,000
2019	Dissertation Write-up Grant, Central European University	\$ 4,200
	Doctoral Research Support Grant, Central European University	\$ 4,500
	Jacobs Foundation Award, SRCD	\$ 2000
2013	K 109352 Research grant, OTKA (Hungarian Research Agency) Researcher, Title: The cognitive bases of naive sociology; PI: Ildikó Király	\$ 51,000
2012	Scholarship and stipend to Leiden University, ERASMUS Fellowship Granted by the Hungarian Republic, Ministry of Education, Hungary Kardos Lajos Psychology Competition, Second place	

Teaching Experience

2026-2027	Belief Change (PSYC/LING/CGSC 4330), Primary Instructor	Yale
2025-2026	Human Communication (PSYC/CGSC/LING 3475), Primary Instructor	Yale
2025-2026	Research Methods in Psychology (PSYC 2200), Primary Instructor	Yale
2024	Developmental Psychology (PSY 16), Teaching Fellow	Harvard
2022	Logic in Language and Thought (CLPS1860), Guest Lecturer	Brown
2019	Lab in Early Cognitive Development (PSY 1652r), Guest Lecturer	Harvard
2015-2019	Infant Cognition, Guest lecturer	CEU
2012-2013	Departmental Teaching Fellow, Department of Cognitive Psychology	ELTE

Mentoring

2025-	Magdalena Roszkowski, postdoctoral mentee	Yale
2025-2026	Katrina Azar, directed research	Yale
2022-2024	Ciara Broomfield, research assistant	Brown
2023-2024	Jaclyn Cohen, research assistant	Brown
2021-2022	Peter Mazalik, research assistant	Brown
2020-2021	Joungbihn Park, research assistant	Brown
2020-2021	Alexandria Elkhadem, research assistant	Brown
2019	Sara Dablouk, Undergraduate intern	Harvard
2019	Laura Mullertz, undergraduate intern	Harvard
2018-2019	Krisztina Andrási, post-bac research assistant	CEU
2017-2018	Eszter Körtvélyesi, post-bac research assistant	CEU
2014	Ágoston Galambos, research assistant	ELTE

Service

EVENT ORGANIZATION

2017	Budapest Conference on Cognitive Science, Co-Chair
2017-2019	Journal club at CEU, Organizer

PEER REVIEW

Journals: Infancy, Child Development, Language Learning and Development, Psychological Review, Inquiry, Cognition, Nous, Journal of Experimental Child Psychology, Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, Psychological Science

Conferences: BCCCD, ELM, COGSCI, BUCLD, SPP